

SYNTHETIC DATA PREPARED FOR AGRONET

Indian Agriculture Guidelines Handbook (2025–2026)

This handbook summarizes current Government of India agricultural guidelines and recommended best practices for educational and RAG testing purposes. Farmers should always consult state-specific advisories and official notifications for operational decisions.

1. Overview of Indian Agriculture

Indian agriculture is based on Kharif, Rabi and Zaid seasons. Good agricultural practices focus on soil health, efficient water use, balanced nutrient management, climate resilience, mechanization and sustainable farming.

2. Seasonal Crop Planning

- Select crops suitable for local agro-climatic conditions.
- Follow recommended sowing windows.
- Use certified seed.
- Maintain field records.
- Diversify cropping systems where feasible.

3. Soil Health Management

- Conduct soil testing periodically.
- Follow Soil Health Card recommendations.
- Increase organic matter through compost and farmyard manure.
- Prevent soil erosion.
- Practice crop rotation.

4. Water Management

- Improve irrigation efficiency.
- Adopt drip or sprinkler irrigation where appropriate.
- Harvest rainwater.
- Maintain field drainage.
- Avoid excessive irrigation.

5. Nutrient Management

- Apply balanced fertilizers.
- Use Integrated Nutrient Management (INM).
- Split nitrogen applications.
- Correct micronutrient deficiencies based on soil tests.
- Encourage organic nutrient sources.

6. Integrated Pest & Disease Management

- Monitor fields regularly.
- Use Integrated Pest Management (IPM).
- Encourage biological control.
- Apply pesticides only when necessary.
- Follow label directions and safety precautions.

7. Farm Mechanization

Mechanization improves productivity through:

- Seed drills
- Planters
- Power tillers
- Tractors
- Harvesters
- Custom Hiring Centres for small farmers.

8. Climate Resilient Agriculture

- Conserve soil moisture.
- Diversify crops.
- Improve water-use efficiency.
- Adopt drought- and flood-resilient practices.
- Monitor weather advisories.

9. Digital Agriculture

Current initiatives promote:

- Digital farmer records
- Digital crop surveys
- Soil information systems
- Decision support systems
- Digital advisory services

10. Major Government Programmes

Important programmes include:

- PM-KISAN
- PMFBY
- PMKSY
- Soil Health Card
- Agriculture Infrastructure Fund
- e-NAM
- National Food Security Mission
- National Mission for Sustainable Agriculture
- Farmer Producer Organisations (FPOs)

11. Harvest and Post-Harvest Management

- Harvest at physiological maturity.
- Clean and grade produce.
- Dry produce to safe moisture.
- Store in clean, dry structures.
- Reduce post-harvest losses.

12. Sustainable Agriculture

Recommended practices:

- Crop diversification
- Integrated farming systems
- Organic matter recycling
- Efficient fertilizer use
- Water conservation
- Biodiversity protection

13. Farmer Best Practices Checklist

Before Season:

- Soil test
- Purchase certified inputs
- Prepare irrigation

During Season:

- Monitor pests
- Apply nutrients on schedule
- Keep farm records

After Harvest:

- Clean storage
- Record production
- Plan next crop

14. Conclusion

Modern Indian agriculture combines scientific crop management, digital technologies, efficient resource use, sustainable farming practices and government support programmes to improve farm productivity, resilience and farmer income.